

“I can get a job, too,” Andrea offered. “I complete my internship in a little more than a week. But school doesn’t start again for nearly three months, so I won’t know about a teaching job for a month or more.”

“Andrea, we’re both going to have to make some sacrifices to pay these debts,” Bill said. “I’ve really been foolish not to see that we were living over our heads. I guess I didn’t want to know. I’m going to Pastor Riggs tomorrow to see if he knows anyone who can help us work out a plan.”

The next day Bill stopped by to see his pastor and told him the overview of what had happened. “Unfortunately, Bill, what has happened to you and Andrea is not unusual today. Too much credit is put in the hands of young people who have little or no idea how to control their use of it. I’m sure Andrea was as shocked as her mother to find out how much she had spent.”

“There’s no question about that, Pastor,” Bill responded. “But I need to know what we can do about it. We’ll pay back everything in time, but right now it looks kind of hopeless.”

“It’s never hopeless if you’re willing to admit your mistakes and correct them,” the pastor commented. “I want you to call one of our elders who heads up our financial coaching program. He’ll work out a time to meet with you and Andrea.”

Bill immediately called Mike McKenna, the elder Pastor Riggs referred him to. “I’ll be glad to see you and Andrea this evening, Bill. I’ll meet you at the church office at seven o’clock, if that’s okay with you.”

“That will be fine,” Bill responded. “And thank you for taking the time.”

“Don’t mention it. That’s my area of ministry to our fellowship. See you tonight at seven.”

At seven o’clock Bill and Andrea were waiting outside the church office. Mike McKenna arrived, and Bill recognized him from a meeting he had attended more than a year ago, when the elder had